

15 July 2026

Q1 Retrieve all columns from the employees table

```
SELECT *  
FROM employees;
```

id	first_name	last_name	department	salary	hire_date	city
1	Alice	Green	IT	70000	2020-01-10	Johannesburg
2	Brian	Lee	HR	45000	2019-03-22	Cape Town
3	Cathy	Zulu	Finance	65000	2018-01-18	Durban
4	David	Mokoena	Marketing	50000	2021-11-05	Pretoria
5	Eva	Naidoo	IT	72000	2017-09-30	Johannesburg

Q2 Find all unique department

```
SELECT DISTINCT department  
FROM employees;
```

department
IT
HR
Finance
Marketing

03 Retrieve first and last names ordered by salary descending.

```
SELECT first_name,  
       last_name  
FROM employees ORDER BY salary DESC;
```

first_name	last_name
Eva	Maidoo
Alice	Green
Cathy	Zulu
David	Mokoena
Brian	Lee

04 Retrieve the top 3 highest-paid employees

```
SELECT id,  
       first_name,  
       last_name,  
       salary  
FROM employees ORDER BY salary DESC LIMIT 3;
```

id	first_name	last_name	salary
5	Eva	Maidoo	72 000
1	Alice	Green	70 000
3	Cathy	Zulu	65 000

05 Find employees in the IT department

```
SELECT id,  
       first_name,  
       last_name,  
       department  
FROM employees WHERE department = 'IT';
```

id	first_name	last_name	department
1	Alice	Green	IT
5	Eva	Maidoo	IT

06 Find employees in Finance with salary > 60 000.

```
SELECT id,  
       first_name,  
       last_name,  
       department,  
       salary  
FROM employees  
WHERE department = 'Finance' AND salary > 60 000;
```

id	first_name	last_name	department	salary
3	Cathy	Zulu	Finance	65 000

7 Find employees in HR or Marketing

```
SELECT id,  
       first_name,  
       last_name,  
       department  
FROM employees  
WHERE department = 'HR'  
OR department = 'Marketing';
```

id	first_name	last_name	department
2	Brian	Lee	HR
4	David	Mokoena	Marketing

8 Find employees not in IT

```
(1) SELECT id,  
       first_name,  
       last_name,  
       department  
FROM employees  
WHERE department <> IT;
```

```
(2) SELECT id,  
       first_name,  
       last_name,  
       department  
FROM employees  
WHERE NOT department = 'IT';
```

id	first_name	last_name	department
2	Brian	Lee	HR
3	Cathy	Zulu	Finance
4	David	Mokoena	Marketing

9. find employees in IT, HR or Finance using IN

```
SELECT id,  
       first_name,  
       last_name,  
       department  
FROM employees  
WHERE department IN ('IT', 'HR', 'Finance');
```

id	first_name	last_name	department
1	Alice	Green	IT
2	Brian	Lee	HR
3	Cathy	Zulu	Finance
5	Eva	Maidoo	IT

10. Find employees in IT with salary > 65 000 and
city Johannesburg.

```
SELECT id,  
       first_name,  
       last_name,  
       department,  
       salary,  
       city
```

```
FROM employees  
WHERE department = 'IT' AND salary > 65 000  
AND city = 'Johannesburg';
```

id	first_name	last_name	department	salary	city
1	Alice	Green	IT	70 000	Johannesburg
5	Eva	Maidoo	IT	72 000	Johannesburg